Thousands of U.S. Students were studied re popularity. The most popular kids had the longest list of people <u>THEY</u> liked.

The fastest way to get people to like you is to like them.

The fastest way to be impressive is to help people impress you.

When we criticize and tear each other down we create gaps of defensiveness that separate us. These gaps eventually lead to distrust → relationships = time spent.

That time spent is not just physical proximity, it is open & honest communication.

What does this have to do with The Fruit of the Spirit?

Fruit of the Spirit <u>is</u>

Nine fruit identified as a single item/collective.

All or nothing
You might fake one or two but, absent the Holy Spirit, you will NOT demonstrate all nine.
Fruit = plucked; we are to spend time with the Holy Spirit, allow those traits to ripen, and allow them to be plucked by the world around us (saved and unsaved)
People are selfish by nature and want to be around people that benefit them. Have something for them to pluck that benefits them and the Kingdom

When someone can pluck joy from you they will want to spend more time in your presence. If they are struggling in their faith and you are covered in the fruit of faith and it is available to them, they can increase their faith by being around you, they will gravitate to you.

Lets look at FAITH

Faith as a Fruit

What is faith? Heb 11:1
Substance: Foundation (of hope)
Evidence: proof (of what is unseen)

How do I get faith? Rom 12:3
<u>The</u> measure / limited portion (seed $)

How do I get more faith? Mar 9:22-24
Ask / Prayer a feeling vs 29
when do we pray a fast? → desperation or discipline

<u>Fruit</u>
Remember that we defined fruit as for either consumption or reproduction

Faith for consumption / whats in it for me?

Hebrews 11:
:2 reputation
:3 understanding
:4 influence
:5 presence of a pleased God

Faith for reproduction
Faith unto death Heb 11:36-40 STAMS
Faith unto life Rom. 10:17

Faith is <u>our</u> part of the New Covenant
Rom 1:17
Heb 10:6-10

Meekness

Gentleness; by implication humility: meekness from prah'os meek only used once, by Christ, to describe himself as our pattern Mat 11:29

Read Matt 11:25-30

* Jesus is giving us the recipe for knowing the Father the way He knows His Father.

1) Come unto me & get saved
2) Take up our cross
   - we each have our own to bear
   - each is unique & designed by Him specifically to grow us
     - Health
     - Age
     - babies
     - who am I
3) Learn from Him (yoke of oxen)
   - Meek (to melt)
     - mild of temper, soft, gentle
     - willing to be second to something or someone else
   - lowly in heart - puts <u>every one</u> else first - James 4:6
4) Find rest unto your soul
   - perfect peace / rest / intermission
   - breathe

* You will <u>Know</u> the Father only with the ingredient of meekness

Gal 6:1 (being "non-carnal") only happens
Eph 4:2 (unity) only happens
Col 3:1-12 (transformation) only happens
1 Tim 6:1-11 (enlightenment) " "
II Tim 2:19-26 (influence) " "
Tit 2:11-3:2 (peace) " "

Temperance - self control *
Continence - loyalty to your own
Belief system

Flower to fruit:
Pollination
fertilization
Seed development
Fruit development

Function of the fruit: The fruit's main function is to spread the seeds and allow the plant to reproduce.

* The missing ingredient in Peter's betrayal.

Falling / Backsliding always carries guilt and shame; regardless of consequences
(illustration) driving home on 52 every night

In II Pet 1:1-10 Peter tells us how to avoid that guilt and shame

*
Diligence - quickly and non-stop
Faith - same as our text
Virtue - manliness, valor, excellence
Knowledge - Science
temperance - self control
patience - cheerful / hopeful endurance
godliness - piety, holiness
brotherly kindness - fraternal love
charity - better love - agape

R A Torrey calls this a Christian built on a foundation of faith

* Only used here. Means to bring your concentrated effort alongside the promises of God